CHAPTER 10
Decline

Over time, the Taj Mahal has suffered from decay, vandalism, and neglect. For a monument where water is so important, leakage has been a terrible problem. Even while Shah Jahan was still alive, his son sent reports to him in jail on what was being done to repair leaks.

Foreign invaders weakened the power of the Moguls. In 1739, Nadir Shah of Persia invaded India and took the Peacock Throne back home. Eight years later he was murdered and his assassins broke up the throne.

Europeans began to establish powerful colonies in India. In 1608, a company in Great Britain first sent trading missions to India. By 1757, the company—the British East India Company—had become the actual ruler of much of India, which had no central government.